

Owner-Builder Compliance Checklist

Everything you MUST have in order before you pick up a tool

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Owner-builders carry significant legal liability. This checklist covers every compliance obligation you need to meet under Queensland law before, during and after your owner-builder project — from QBCC permits to insurance to sale disclosure obligations.

BEFORE YOU START — MANDATORY

✓	ITEM	RESULT	NOTES
■	QBCC Owner-Builder Permit obtained (projects over \$11,000)		
■	Owner-Builder Permit displayed on site (legal requirement)		
■	Building Permit issued by private certifier or council		
■	Site is owner-occupied (or meets QBCC exemption criteria)		
■	Asbestos inspection complete if pre-1990 dwelling		
■	Site safety plan prepared		
■	All licensed trades engaged for required work (electrical, plumbing)		
■	Insurance — Owner-Builder Run-Off Cover considered		

SITE SAFETY

✓	ITEM	RESULT	NOTES
■	Site fencing erected (required if near public access)		
■	Overhead line clearance — contact Energex if within 3m		
■	Temporary facilities — toilet and water on site		
■	Personal protective equipment on site		
■	First aid kit accessible at all times		
■	Hot works plan if cutting/welding near combustibles		
■	Excavation — call Dial Before You Dig (1100)		
■	Fall protection — scaffolding or edge protection as required		

LICENSED TRADES (CANNOT DO YOURSELF)

✓	ITEM	RESULT	NOTES
■	All electrical work — licensed electrician only		
■	All plumbing — licensed plumber only		
■	Gas fitting — licensed gasfitter only		
■	Structural engineering — licensed engineer sign-off		
■	Asbestos removal >10m ² — licensed removalist only		
■	Pool safety inspections — licensed pool inspector		

INSPECTION HOLD POINTS

✓	ITEM	RESULT	NOTES
■	Footing inspection — before concrete pour		
■	Slab inspection — before concrete pour		
■	Frame inspection — before any lining		
■	Pre-plaster inspection — before plasterboard		
■	Final inspection — before occupation		
■	Certificate of Occupancy received before moving in		

BEFORE SELLING — DISCLOSURE OBLIGATIONS

✓	ITEM	RESULT	NOTES
■	Owner-Builder Defects Report obtained (if selling within 6.5 years)		
■	Defects report from licensed building inspector (QBCC-required)		
■	Report provided to buyers BEFORE contract exchange		
■	QBCC owner-builder permit details disclosed in contract		
■	Home Warranty Insurance — check if required for your project value		
■	All receipts, plans, approvals retained for disclosure		

■ **PRO TIP FROM CARL GRAHAM — 40 YEARS IN THE TRADE** The single biggest mistake owner-builders make is not getting an independent inspection BEFORE they list. A defects report protects YOU legally and gives buyers confidence. At C Graham Constructions, we provide QBCC-compliant owner-builder defects reports across Southeast Queensland. Call 0476 015 224.